

13 Construction

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Vocabulary 1: describing your home

A Match the words and phrases with the pictures.

apartment/flat detached house terraced house cottage bungalow beach house



B Check the highlighted words in the questions below and think about your answers.

1. Is the house or apartment/flat you live in **modern** or old? When was it **built**?
2. If you live in an apartment/flat, is it part of a big house or in an **apartment block/a block of flats**?
3. If you live in an apartment/flat, what **floor** is it on? (**ground floor/first floor**)
4. Do you (or your parents) **own** your house or apartment/flat or do you/they **rent** it?
5. How many **rooms** are there in your house or apartment/flat?
6. How big is your **bedroom/living room/bathroom**?
7. Do you have a **separate dining room** or do you eat in the **kitchen**?
8. Do you have a room that you use as a **study**?
9. Do you have a **spare bedroom** or a **guest room**?
10. Do you have a **garden** or a **roof terrace**?
11. Do any of the windows have a **balcony**?
12. Are there **good views** from the **windows/balconies/roof terrace**?

Speaking 1: talking about homes

A Talk with a partner. Say what type of home you have and then answer the questions in Exercise B above.

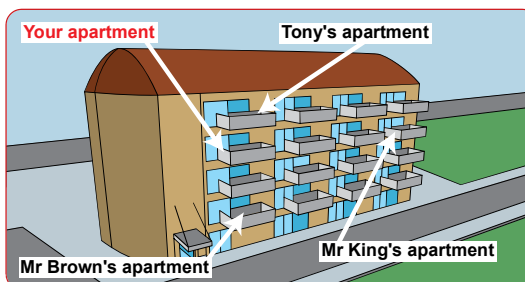
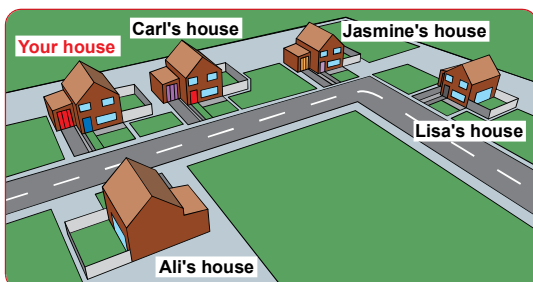
Grammar check

You can say *There are six bedrooms in my house* or *My house has six bedrooms*.
Is there a study? or Do you have a study?



Exam tip: You have practised talking about towns and cities and now talking about homes. In the first part of the Speaking Module, the examiner may ask you about both. Make sure you learn the words and phrases that help you to talk about your life.

Vocabulary 2: your neighbourhood



A Look at the street plan and notice where your house is. Check the highlighted phrases in the questions and then answer them with a partner.

1. Who lives in the house **next door**? _____
2. Who lives in the house **opposite** / **across the road**? _____
3. Who lives **just down the road**? _____
4. Who lives **just round the corner**? _____

B Look at the apartment block and notice where your apartment is. Check the highlighted words and phrases in the questions and then answer them with a partner.

1. Who lives in the flat **upstairs** / **above** yours?
2. Who lives in the flat **downstairs** / **below** yours?
3. Who lives **on the same floor** as you?

C Talk with a partner about your neighbourhood. Who lives near you?

Speaking 2: contrasting ideas

A Listen to some students describing their homes. Which statement below is true?

1. They all like everything about their home.
2. None of them likes anything about their home.
3. They all have mixed feelings about their homes.

B Listen again and fill each space with **one word**. Notice the incomplete highlighted phrases.

1. **On the other** _____, it's very close to where I work.
2. My room is small but **I** _____ it's cheap.
3. _____, our neighbours are not very friendly.
4. **On the** _____ **side**, it's very central.

Pronunciation check

Listen again to sentences 1, 3 and 4 in Exercise B. Notice how the speaker pauses when a linking device introduces a contrast. Practise saying the sentences.

C Talk with a partner about your house or apartment and your neighbourhood. Say what you like and don't like. Contrast your opinions with the phrases from Exercise B above.

Listening

13

Listening 1: preparing to listen

A Here are two typical cards for part 2 of the Speaking Module. Work with a partner – one of you is A, the other is B. You have a minute to think about it and make notes.

A

Describe a building you think is beautiful.

Say ...

- where the building is.
- why it was built / what it's used for.
- when it was built, if you know.
- what you like about it.

B

Describe a building you think is ugly.
Say ...

- where the building is.
- why it was built / what it's used for.
- when it was built, if you know.
- what you don't like about it.

B Take it in turns to speak about what's on your card for about two minutes.

C Look at the picture. Answer the questions with a partner.

1. What is the building?
2. Where is it?
3. When was it built?
4. Why was it built?
5. Why do people think it is so beautiful?



Listening 2: spelling answers correctly

A You will hear a tour guide talking to some tourists about the Taj Mahal. Read the notes below and predict any answers you can.

B Listen and complete the notes that one of the tourists made. Use one word only for each answer.

The (1) _____ have a sense of symmetry – same on both sides of building.

A large (2) _____ reflects the building – popular place for photos.

On top of the building is the (3) _____. People wonder at how the building can support its (4) _____.

There are four minarets – one in each corner. Story of the Taj Mahal is very (5) _____. 1629 – Shah Jahan's (6) _____ wife died. He was so sad that his (7) _____ turned white.

He decided to build a beautiful (8) _____ to remember her by. Work started in 1632.

C Mark each of the words 1–8 in the task like this:

- | | |
|---|----------|
| A I know this word and it's easy to spell. | 1. _____ |
| B I know this word but it's difficult to spell. | 2. _____ |
| C I don't know this word but I can guess how to spell it quite easily. | 3. _____ |
| D I don't know this word and I have no idea how to spell it. | 4. _____ |
| | 5. _____ |
| | 6. _____ |
| | 7. _____ |
| | 8. _____ |



Exam tip: In the Listening Module of the exam, you **MUST** spell answers correctly. Even if it is clear that you heard a word on the recording, you will not get a mark if it is spelt wrongly. Revise the spelling of all words you know and look at spelling patterns so that you can guess how to spell words that you don't know.

Listening 3: practise spelling answers correctly

A The building in this picture is the Millennium Dome in London. Some people say it's the ugliest building in the world. Why don't they like it?



B Listen to part of a lecture that an architect is giving about the Millennium Dome. Read the summary below before you listen.

For questions 1–8, complete the summary with words that you hear. Use no more than two words for each answer.

The speaker says that there are many ugly buildings, like (1) _____ blocks, but that the Millennium Dome is different. It was built to (2) _____ the beginning of a new century. It took a long time to plan and construct and it cost nearly (3) _____ pounds. He thinks it is the building's ugliness that makes it (4) _____.

The speaker mentions two buildings in the US that he thinks are also ugly – the public (5) _____ in Chicago and a museum in Seattle. However, he thinks the Dome is a (6) _____ example of design. The speaker agrees that the Dome has an (7) _____ design and impressive engineering, but he is disappointed with it.

The speaker says that the Dome will now be used to stage (8) _____ events.

C Check the key on page 272. How many questions did you answer correctly?

D Answer these questions about the listening task with a partner and think about how you can answer more questions correctly next time.

1. Which answers did you hear but spell wrongly?
2. Which answers did you hear and spell correctly?
3. Which words did you already know how to spell?
4. Which words did you have to guess the spelling of?
5. Are you happy with how many questions you answered and spelt correctly?

Key vocabulary in context

These verbs from the two extracts have been used in the wrong sentences. Correct the exercise.

1. The building was **reflected** by an American architect.
2. It will take at least five years to **celebrate** the new stadium.
3. When the new shopping centre opens, there will be a party to **support**.
4. In hot countries, houses are white so that they **design** sunlight back.
5. That bridge doesn't look strong enough to **construct** so much traffic.

Reading 1: preparing to read

A Look at the map and the picture and answer the questions with a partner.

1. What do you call a construction like this?
2. What is its purpose?
3. Where is this construction?
4. When was it built?
5. Why was it built here?
6. How has it changed the lives of people in the country?



B Check the meaning of these. How are they related to the topic?

flooding agriculture reservoir overflow concrete electricity

Reading 2: coping with longer texts

A Look at the text on the next page but do not read it yet. Tick the statements that are true for you.

1. I don't usually read texts this long in English. _____
2. It takes me a long time to read a long text like this. _____
3. I think it is more difficult to understand a long text than a short text. _____
4. There is usually more difficult vocabulary in a longer text. _____
5. I think it will be more difficult to find the information I need if the text is long. _____
6. By the time I get to the end, I have forgotten the beginning. _____



Exam tip: The third part of the Reading Module is the most difficult and the text will be longer. It will be an article from a newspaper, magazine or journal or an extract from a book. There will probably be more than one task to do.

B Here is some advice about coping with longer texts. Complete each sentence with one word.

1. Read the _____ of the text and look at any pictures or diagrams with it.
2. Skim the text quickly for gist. A good idea is to read the _____ sentence at the beginning of each paragraph and the final line of the text. Notice any key words that are repeated in the text.
3. Read the _____ for the tasks carefully before reading the text again so that you have a purpose for reading and you know what to look for. Think about which parts of the text you will need to look at again for each task.

4. As you read again, don't worry about the meaning of every _____ and phrase. This will slow you down and is not necessary to answer questions.
5. Once you know which part of the text provides an _____, read it very carefully. If you don't know the meaning of a key word or phrase, guess it from the _____.



Exam tip: Try not to be afraid of a text because it is long. You probably won't have to read every part, and you won't have to understand every word. Don't try to read the whole text before you know what you are looking for. You will not remember enough to answer questions.

Reading 3: practise reading longer texts

A Look again at the questions in Reading 1A and 1B and remember your answers. Then skim the text to check your ideas.

B Look carefully at the instructions and then read the passage to answer questions 1–17.

The Aswan High Dam

- A** The River Nile is the longest river in the world and it has always brought life to Egypt. Around 95% of the population of Egypt lives within 20 kilometres of this great source of water. When the Aswan High Dam was completed in 1970, it affected every person in the country. The dam prevented flooding that had previously destroyed homes and crops, it generated electricity and it provided water for a much greater programme of agriculture.
- B** There is a long history of attempting to control the Nile. Over 1,000 years ago, the Egyptian rulers first understood the importance of controlling the river and employed engineers to plan a dam of some sort. At that time, engineering and technological limitations meant that completing a successful project was impossible. Over the years, several architects were put in prison for not finding a solution.
- C** The beginning of the last century saw the first real attempt to build a dam on the Nile and there are, in fact, still two dams at Aswan. The first dam, the low dam, was constructed between 1889 and 1902 but never achieved what it was supposed to. It was soon discovered that the dam was not high enough and it was raised. Major work was carried out between 1907 and 1912 and then again between 1929 and 1933.
- In 1946, the dam very nearly overflowed again, and this time it was decided that a second dam was the solution. It was to be built six kilometres upriver from the first dam.
- D** Planning for this second dam began in 1954, and construction began six years later. The dam was made of rock and covered with concrete. When construction was complete, the dam was 111 metres high and 1,000 metres wide. The dam's volume was over 44 million cubic metres. That is like building the Great Pyramid at Giza seventeen times. The reservoir created by the dam became the world's third largest reservoir and was called Lake Nasser. The lake is now 90 metres deep and covers an area 500 kilometres long and, at its widest point, 35 kilometres wide. 11,000 square metres of water can pass through the dam every second.
- E** The High Dam has brought many benefits. Land that was previously desert is now provided with water and is used for farming. The floods that hit the farmland along the river once a year no longer destroy the crops. Far more food is produced, and there is less need to import products from other countries. The dam powers 12 generators and produces half of Egypt's electricity production. When the dam was first built, many villages had electricity for the first time. A new fishing industry has developed around Lake Nasser and thousands of jobs have been created.
- F** As with any project of this size, there have been problems, too. The annual floods, though destructive, brought nutrients to the soil. There is now more farmland, but it is not as fertile as it once was. When Lake Nasser was first formed, flooding displaced around 90,000 people and new homes had to be provided for them. Several important archaeological sites were in danger from the new lake, and archaeologists had to move monuments to safer locations or give them to other countries. Fishing in the Mediterranean was badly affected as nutrients that flowed down the Nile and into the sea were trapped behind the dam. Water below the dam now moves more slowly, and many more people suffer from resulting diseases.
- G** Despite these problems, the construction of the Aswan High Dam and the creation of Lake Nasser has been a huge success and a great engineering achievement. Ask any Egyptian and he will tell you that the project has greatly improved the lives of most people. The project has shown how similar problems can be overcome in other countries and has had a huge influence on similar projects that aim to irrigate land that was once desert.

The reading passage has seven paragraphs, labelled A–G.

For questions 1–7, choose the most suitable heading for each paragraph from the list A–J in the box below. You do not need all the headings.

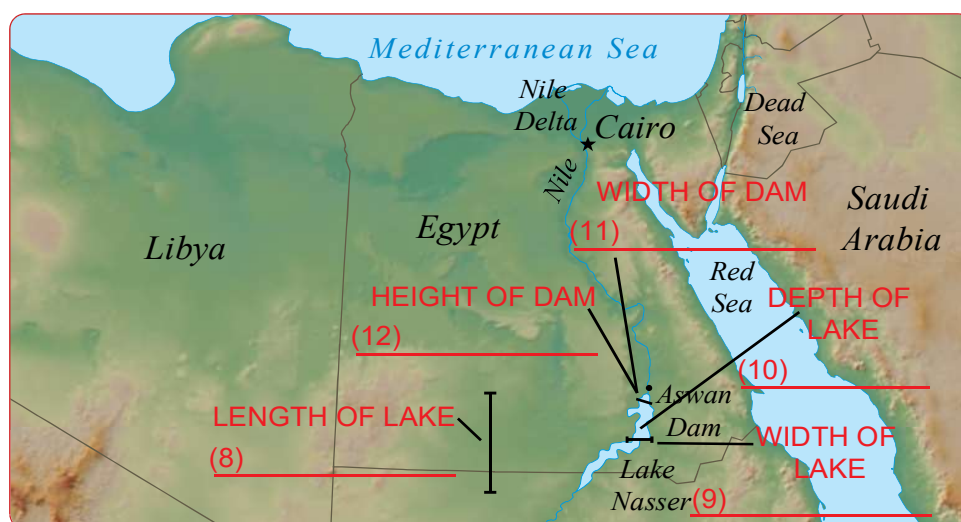
- | | |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| A Not all good news | B A terrible accident |
| C Others can learn from the project | D Most Egyptians live on the Nile |
| E A number of improvements | F The world's biggest dam |
| G A very old problem | H Everyone's a fisherman now |
| I Not quite right – try again | J A huge project |

1. paragraph A ____ 2. paragraph B ____ 3. paragraph C ____ 4. paragraph D ____
5. paragraph E ____ 6. paragraph F ____ 7. paragraph G ____



Question-type tip: A common task for a longer text is matching headings with paragraphs. The instructions can be quite complicated – you may have letters, numbers and Roman numerals to look at. Read the instructions carefully and make sure you know what you have to write in the spaces.

For questions 8–12, complete the diagram with information from the text.



For questions 13–17, choose five answers from A–H.

Which of the following benefits and problems are mentioned?

- | | |
|------------------------------------|---|
| A homes destroyed | B electricity in more homes |
| C work for people near Lake Nasser | D bigger catches of fish in the seas around Egypt |
| E people becoming sick | F more Egyptian exports |
| G changes to historic sites | H better soil |

13. ____ 14. ____ 15. ____ 16. ____ 17. ____

C Check the key on page 272. How many questions did you answer correctly?

D Tick the sentences about the reading task that are true for you and think about how you can answer more questions correctly next time.

- The length of the text didn't worry me.
- Skimming the text first helped me get a general idea of what it is about.
- I looked at the questions carefully, so I knew what to look for when I read more carefully.
- I am happy with how many of the questions I answered correctly.

WB For focus on reading skills and key vocabulary in context, go to Workbook page 37.

Writing 1: preparing to write**A** Answer these questions with a partner.

1. In your country, do most people own a house or apartment or do they rent one?
2. Where do people live when they leave their parents' house?
3. Do students rent an apartment if they leave their hometown to study?

**B** Check the highlighted words and answer the questions with the same partner.

1. What or who is a **tenant**?
2. What is a **letting agency**?
3. What is a **landlord** or **landlady**?
4. What is a **deposit**?

C In small groups, make a list of the possible problems that tenants can have when they rent a house or apartment.

Perhaps the cooker or fridge doesn't work properly.

D  Listen to some people talking about problems they had when they rented an apartment. Did you mention any of the same things?**Writing 2: planning the composition****A** Look at the instructions for a writing task below. Highlight the key words and check that you understand what you have to do.

You have just rented an apartment from a letting agency. You paid a deposit and a month's rent in advance. You now realize that the apartment is not in very good condition. It is summer, but the air conditioning does not work. The furniture is old and some of it is broken, and the apartment was not cleaned well before you moved in.

Write a letter to the agency explaining the problem and telling them what you want them to do. Write at least 150 words. You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.

B Talk with a partner and answer these questions about the writing task.

1. Is this a situation you can relate to? If it is not, can you use your imagination?
2. Do you know how to start and finish the letter?
3. Do you have ideas for what to include in the main part of the letter?
4. Are you going to use formal or informal language?

C Look at a student's letter on the next page. Is it similar to the letter that you planned to write? Do you like it?**D** Look at these teacher's comments about the letter. Tick the one that is true.

1. There is a problem with content. You don't explain the problem or say what you want done.
2. It is not well organized. The points are not made in a logical order.
3. There is a problem with spelling and punctuation.

Dear Sir/Madam

I am writing to complane about an apartment that I am renting through your letting agency it is flat 3 at 74 belle view gardens I moved in a week ago and payed a deposit of £600 and a months rent in advans which was £750 I now realize that the apartment is not in a good condition and I am not at all happy

firstly the air conditioning is not working properly so the apartment is very hot all the time I have found it very dificult to sleep until late at night in this hot wether

secondly most of the ferniture is very old and some of it is broken the leg of the coffee table in the living room is broken and some cuboard doors do not close properly finally you told me that the apartment would be cleaned before I moved in however when I arived it was very dirty and I spent all day cleaning it myself

I am very disapointed and would like you to resolve the problem as soon as possible please arrange for the air conditioning to be repared immediately then please contact the landlord about replasing the broken ferniture finally please refund a percentage of the advance I have paid for not cleaning the apartment properly I think £100 would be fair

I look forward to hearing from you

Your faithfully

Marco Bendetti

Writing 3: spelling and punctuation

A Look again at only the first paragraph of the composition. Complete the following tasks. Then check your answers on page 272.

1. There should be four sentences. Put in four full stops, including one at the end of the paragraph. Begin all new sentences with a capital letter.
2. There should be one comma. Put it in the right place.
3. One word should have an apostrophe before an 's'. Put it in.
4. Make sure that any names begin with a capital letter. There are three examples.
5. Three words are spelled wrongly. Correct them here.

B Look at the second paragraph and complete the tasks.

1. There should be two sentences. Put in two full stops, including one at the end of the paragraph. Begin all new sentences with a capital letter.
2. There should be one comma. Put it in the right place.
3. Two words are spelt wrongly. Correct them here. _____

C Look at the third paragraph and complete the tasks.

1. There should be four sentences. Put in four full stops, including one at the end of the paragraph. Make sure any words that start a new sentence begin with a capital letter.
2. There should be three commas. Put them in.
3. Three words are spelt wrongly. Correct them here.

D Look at the final paragraph and the closing phrases. Correct any errors of punctuation and spelling. Then check your answers to all the tasks on page 272.

WB Go to Workbook page 37 for the writing task.

Speaking

A Here are four typical cards for part 2 of the Speaking Module. Work with a partner. Choose a card. You have a minute to think about it and make notes.

A

Talk about your neighbourhood.

Say ...

- what type of houses there are.
- what sort of people live there.
- what you like about it.
- what you would like to change.

C

Describe a city that has a lot of interesting old buildings.

Say ...

- which city it is.
- which buildings are interesting.
- when some of the buildings were built.
- which building is your favourite and why.

B

Describe the home of a friend or family member.

Say ...

- what type of building it is.
- how many rooms it has.
- when it was built.
- what you like about it.

D

Describe a city that has a lot of interesting modern buildings.

Say ...

- which city it is.
- what is interesting about the buildings.
- what some of the buildings are used for.
- which building is your favourite and why.

B Take it in turns to speak about what's on your card for about two minutes.

Vocabulary

A Match each word 1–6 with a word a–f to make common phrases.

- | | |
|---------------|------------|
| 1. apart ment | a. hose |
| 2. spare | b. terrace |
| 3. beach | c. room |
| 4. ground | d. block |
| 5. roof | e. door |
| 6. next | f. floor |

B Delete the wrong suffix in each of these words made from the root words in the box.

- The new library is not my favourite build *er* / *ing*.
- There is a lot of construct *ment* / *ion* along the coast.
- A mirror shows your reflect *ment* / *ion*.
- We live in a very nice neighbour *hood* / *ation*.
- We had a big celebrat *ing* / *ion* at the end of the school year.

buil d
const ruct
ref lect
neighbour
cel ebrate

C Correct the spelling mistakes in these words.

- | | |
|----------------------|--------------------|
| 1. agrakulture _____ | 2. atempt _____ |
| 3. concrite _____ | 4. cottidge _____ |
| 5. elictisity _____ | 6. gest room _____ |
| 7. oposit _____ | 8. seperate _____ |

Errors

A There are errors in all of these sentences. Correct them.

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. There have five bedrooms my house. | 2. My apartment is in the second floor. |
| 3. I live in a house opposite to the park. | 4. We live in the ground floor. |
| 5. I live in the same street than my cousin. | 6. When was built the Taj Mahal? |

Reading

A Look again at the advice about reading longer texts in the reading section of this unit.

B Read the passage and answer questions 1–16.

The Oldest Building in the World?

- A** So what is the oldest man-made structure in the world? In the last ten years, archaeologists in Japan say they have answered that question – twice! However, the second discovery, made by one of Japan's leading archaeologists, was shown to be a case of fraud*.
- B** In 2000, the remains of an ancient building were discovered on a hillside in Chichibu, a small town to the north of Tokyo. Soon afterwards, at Kamitakamori, 600 miles to the north, a second discovery was made. In a layer of earth, archaeologists found large holes which they believed had held posts that had supported a primitive building, and several stone tools that had been used to construct it.
- C** The Chichibu discovery was one of the most important for many years, and both archaeologists and historians were very excited. Ten holes in the shape of two pentagons were discovered. These holes were made for posts that would have supported some kind of structure, like a hut. Thirty tools were also found. The site was dated to half a million years ago. Before the discovery, the oldest remains of a human structure were in France and dated back to around 300,000 years ago.
- D** Experts do not know whether the huts were used as permanent accommodation, or if they had a temporary function as a shelter or as a lookout for hunters. It is thought that primitive people at that time lived in caves and did not build houses of any kind. The discovery was important because it showed that 500,000 years ago Man had the ability to use technology in ways that we previously did not think were possible.
- E** Later in 2000, at the Kamitakamori site, archaeologists said that they had made a discovery that was 100,000 years older than the one at Chichibu. They found a number of deep holes and predicted that they had the same function as those at Chichibu. They believed that two round buildings had existed at the site. Several tools were discovered in a hole at the centre of the site.
- F** However, in 2003, the truth came out. A senior archaeologist had planted the tools so that he could take credit for such an important discovery. He buried stone tools that he had previously found at another site and covered them in soil. Unfortunately for him, his actions were caught on camera, and a national newspaper then told the whole story. The archaeologist explained that he had committed his crime because of the pressure on him to keep making important discoveries.
- G** The same archaeologist had worked on a number of very important archaeological projects before the Kamitakamori incident. He admitted that he had planted artefacts on other occasions. Some experts believe that there is now a question mark over some of Japan's historical records, and they want further investigation. It seems that we cannot be sure about what or where the world's oldest building really is.



* The crime of pretending something to be true when it is not (usually in order to get money).

For questions 1–4, use no more than two words from the passage for each answer.

1. Before the Chichibu discovery, in which country had the oldest building been found?

2. What type of simple building do archaeologists believe once existed at the Chichibu site?

3. What shape were the buildings that were said to have once existed at the Kamitakamori site?

4. What did the senior archaeologist bury at the Kamitakamori site?

The passage has seven paragraphs, lettered A–G. For questions 5–9, say in which paragraph you find the following information. Write the letter in the space.

- | | |
|--|-------|
| 5. why somebody was dishonest | _____ |
| 6. that primitive buildings may not have been houses | _____ |
| 7. the result of somebody's dishonest actions | _____ |
| 8. where the archaeological sites are exactly | _____ |
| 9. how experts felt about the discovery at Chichibu | _____ |

For questions 10–16, complete the summary with words from the box. You do not need to use all the words.

Use capital letters if necessary.

earlier	similar	new	posts	round	later	tools
	structures	soil	different	half	real	

In 2000, an important archaeological discovery was made at Chichibu in Japan. The remains of a building, dating back (10) _____ a million years, were found. There were ten holes that experts believed had been used to hold (11) _____. These posts had been used to support a structure of some kind. (12) _____ used to construct the building were also found at the site. Then, a second discovery was made. Some very (13) _____ holes were discovered at another site, and these were said to date back to an even (14) _____ time. In 2003, the world learnt that the second discovery was not (15) _____. A senior archaeologist had planted the artefacts. He said that archaeologists were under pressure to keep making (16) _____ discoveries.



Exam tip: This is the summary of the whole text. However, you will sometimes have a summary that summarizes only part of a text, and you will first have to identify which part it summarizes.